

MSI Mega Player 540

Mega Bite Of Entertainment, Anyone?

The Mega Player 540, introduced by MSI, is sure to catch people's fancy. Housed in an elegant white case, this player has the feel of an iPod, but has distinct looks. The 1.8-inch colour OLED with its vibrant colours is a treat for your eyes. A five-way navigation button allows for easy control with just one hand. Ergonomics has also been paid attention to. The 540 is capable of playing MP3 and WMA files in addition to M-JPEG video files and JPEG photos. The 4 GB hard drive can store enough songs to keep you going for hours. The device also has an FM receiver and recorder. We found the bass and volume levels too low, though. The Mega Player 540 provides around 7 hours of playback. It connects to the PC via the USB 2.0 interface, and USB 2.0 OTG lets you connect it directly to compliant devices.

Company **Micro Star International**

Price **Rs 8,500**

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Rating



Western Digital Raptor X WD1500ADEF

Finally, a hard drive for gaming enthusiasts—combining pure performance and innovative looks that will drive PC modders crazy. Western Digital's Raptor X WD1500ADEF has a clear top—allowing you to peek inside the drive while it toils. At 10000 rpm, this is the world's fastest SATA 150 drive. NCQ enables high data transfer speeds in multi-processor, multi-threaded environments. RAFF technology prevents the drive's performance suffering due to vibrations. This drive performs very silently. 75 MBps in the sequential data transfer test makes this drive the fastest we have tested so far—this means games loading faster. The cost of Rs 17,500 is not a surprise for such high performance devices, but that is still too much for just 150 GB.

Company **Western Digital**

Price **Rs 17,500**

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Rating



New & Notable

JVC GR-DF570AC mini DV Camcorder

Let's Get Set To Shoot!

The JVC GR-DF570AC mini DV Camcorder is JVC's newest offering for the Indian market. It uses Mini DV tape and conforms to the PAL video standard, which is what is used in India. The aspherical lens creates an image that is evenly focused from the centre to the edge. The stabilisation mechanism is so amazing, it produces remarkable results even when using the 15x zoom. The 2.5 inch, 180-degree swivel, active matrix system LCD produces a vivid display, but is not of much use outdoors. But the colour viewfinder with a dioptre corrector does excellent work under outdoor conditions.

The S-video connector lets you dub to a VCR or DVD recorder, and the Mini DV port allows loss-free video transfer to a PC. Still photos can be transferred to the PC from the memory card via USB 2.0. This camcorder is compatible with the DPOF standard, ensuring support for future systems, including features such as automatic printing.

The one-touch recording is easy enough for novices to master. The rotary switch provides an intuitive interface,

and the five-second record feature is great for capturing snippets of special moments. Inbuilt Wiper/Fader effects let you make professional-looking scene transitions. The Backlight Compensation function brightens a subject that would otherwise appear dark due to a backlight. The stereo microphone records and plays back sound in real 3D acoustic fields using the camera's

Biphonic recording and playback feature.

The GR-DF570AC is not just a good camcorder, but also a 1.3-megapixel digital camera that allows you shoot photos at 1024 x 768. This camcorder also works as a Webcam.

The camera's battery lasts 55 minutes with the LCD on, and about 65 minutes when the viewfinder is used, which may not be enough. The bundled Cyberlink PowerProducer video editing suite, however, makes this a complete home studio package.

Company **JVC**

Price **Rs 35,900**

Phone **011-26102975**

E-mail **NA**

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Rating

